

3.5 Organising Your Model Using Layers

Now that you have got used to most of the tools needed to make a 3D model, you are all equipped to make the most complex models you ever thought of! The problem which many face after a while is organising their models, as it becomes a tedious task to handle lots of different sized surfaces. Making changes after such a model is complete is one of the most difficult tasks and to solve this problem, we have the Layer Manager.

As always, navigate to Window > Layers. This opens a Layer Dialog which initially shows only Layer0 (and Layer1 generally). Each layer has a visibility option (Checked by default) and a box specifying the colour for that layer. So in the beginning, by default, all your work is



The Layer Manager

saved in one main layer (Generally layer0). Dividing your model into smaller layers, helps view one particular layer at one time, thus making editing layers a simpler task.

So, we begin by selecting similar objects, say the roof. Choose the Select Tool and hold Shift as you select all the roof-tops. You can also right-click one of the roof-tops and choose Select > All with same material. Of course, this works only when you already have applied different texture to each type of surfaces. Again right-click on the selected surface(s) and choose Entity Info. This opens the Entity Info dialog.

The Entity dialog shows the objects selected and the layers they are contained in, apart from other options like Total Area covered by the selected surface and setting shadow and visibility settings for them. So let's make a new layer for the roof-tops. Go back to the Layers dialog and press the [+] button to add another layer in the list of layers. Enter the name as Roof. Now in the Entity Info dialog, choose the layer as Roof from the drop down list.